

1. GAME OVERVIEW

- Players: 2-4. Build a village above ground and explore caverns below over 7 rounds.
- Assign ready villagers to actions, gain goods and coins, recruit villagers, construct buildings, and resolve encounters.
- The player with the most Village Points after final scoring wins.

2. SETUP CHRONOLOGY

- Each player takes a player board, 7 coins, a starting house, 3 starting villagers, and a matching reputation cube. Place villagers in the ready area; apply the special four-player first-round rule.
- Place the reputation board centrally, the round marker on the first of 7 rounds, and each reputation cube on the torch space.
- Display 6 star houses, 4 random key houses, 5 villagers, 4 houses, and 4 outposts. Prepare cave cards, goods, coins, cider, potions, dice, and the Encounter Book.
- Choose the first player. In a two-player game, the second player receives 1 additional coin.

3. TYPICAL TABLE SETUP



4. ROUND AND TURN FLOW

- Beginning with the first player, take one action by assigning the required number of ready villagers. Play continues clockwise.
- Choose from Harvest, Build, Train, Labor, or Explore. A player may pass and take no more turns that round.
- After all players pass, advance the round marker, refresh displays as directed, move exhausted villagers to ready, and pass the first-player card clockwise.
- The game ends after round 7.

5. FIVE MAIN ACTIONS

- Harvest: take a good from one of your buildings and place the assigned villager on that building.
- Build: assign a villager with a hammer and buy one available house or outpost; an outpost requires an empty cave.
- Train: assign a villager with a quill and pay the cost to recruit one available villager.
- Labor: assign a villager to gain 1 coin; the first worker each round also gains the cider token.
- Explore: assign at least 2 villagers, discard a cave card, roll, read the matching encounter, and choose a listed response.

6. REST & READINESS

- Assigned villagers normally become exhausted after their action.
- Potions and cider help return villagers to the ready area according to their printed effects.
- Plan action order so key skill symbols remain available when needed.

7. GOODS & REPUTATION

- Place acquired goods on the advancement track from left to right.
- Different goods and sets can increase end-game Village Points.
- Encounter choices may raise or lower reputation; reputation position scores or loses points at game end.

8. FINAL SCORING

- Add points from buildings and outposts, the goods advancement track, reputation, and other printed effects.
- Coins are worth 1 Village Point each.
- Highest total wins. Follow the rulebook tie-breaker if totals match.

QUICK DECISION CHECK

Before acting: Which skill symbols are required? Will these villagers still be needed later this round?

For exploration: compare encounter rewards, difficulty numbers, reputation effects, and the cost of failure.